

The seasons, as drafted

Five records, one per year, from the site's season data. Everything here is marked draft on the site until you two correct it. Cross out, rewrite in the margin, or just tell me what's wrong by year, and I'll change the file and turn the draft flag off. The 2025 and 2026 wording is Jay's from the spec; 2022 through 2024 are my reading of the results.

2022

The first marathon

WHAT IT WAS FOR

Get from an 8-mile fun run to 26.2 for Jay's fiftieth, one distance at a time.

WHAT IT COST

A summer of long runs that started in the dark, and the first real idea of what recovery takes past forty.

WHAT WE CHANGED

We stopped treating a race as something you show up to and started treating the long run as the thing you earn it with.

YOUR CORRECTIONS

2023

The year we filmed every week

WHAT IT WAS FOR

Volume, and finding out whether the sport would stick. Twenty-seven races, an Olympic tri, a 70.3, a lap of the island, and the whole readiness series.

WHAT IT COST

Most of a year of 5 a.m. alarms, a rib, and a lot of weekends.

WHAT WE CHANGED

The trainers came into the house in October and the weekday bike started actually happening.

YOUR CORRECTIONS

2024

The build

WHAT IT WAS FOR

Fourteen races on healthy bodies, and Michelle's first 70.3.

WHAT IT COST

Less than it should have. This was the year the work paid out: the marathon came down to 3:41 and 4:39.

WHAT WE CHANGED

We decided on the full distance, and the training got pointed at one thing.

YOUR CORRECTIONS

2025

Peak

WHAT IT WAS FOR

Two full Ironmans, a 112-mile lap of the island, a pentathlon, and two 70.3s, on bodies that went in healthy.

WHAT IT COST

The bill arrived at the end of it. Michelle ran the December marathon injured, and 5:25:08 together is what that looked like.

WHAT WE CHANGED

We stopped adding races and started asking what the next year was for.

YOUR CORRECTIONS

2026

Recovery and rebuild

WHAT IT WAS FOR

Slower times on purpose, on bodies that spent two years at peak volume.

WHAT IT COST

Some pride, in the ledger. Every 2026 time sits next to a faster one from 2025.

WHAT WE CHANGED

The volume came down before the body made us bring it down.

YOUR CORRECTIONS
